

QUESTIONS	ANSWERS
What is the fundamental distinction between a mortgage field inspection and a traditional home inspection?	A mortgage field inspection is objective documentation for a lender, while a home inspection is a subjective, diagnostic evaluation for a buyer or seller.
In mortgage field services, what is the primary operational goal for an inspection?	The primary goal is risk mitigation and collateral preservation for the mortgage lender or servicer.
Who is the primary client for a traditional home inspection?	The primary client is typically the home buyer, seller, or real estate agent.
A mortgage field inspector's reporting style should be objective documentation of observable facts, whereas a home inspector's style is ____.	evaluative diagnosis and repair recommendations
According to Fannie Mae's servicing guidelines, a property inspection must be ordered on or after the ____ day of delinquency.	90th
If a loan remains delinquent, how often must property inspections be conducted to monitor for abandonment or deterioration?	Inspections must continue every 30 days.
What is the legal term for the neglect or destruction of property that reduces the value of a lender's security?	Waste.
What is the purpose of a Loss Draft inspection?	To verify the progress of repairs on a property with an insurance claim before the lender releases escrowed funds.
What does the acronym PCR stand for in the mortgage field services industry?	Property Condition Report.
The contractual timeline governing the delivery of an inspection is known as the ____.	Service Level Agreement (SLA)
What is the most critical question a mortgage field inspector must answer during an inspection?	The occupancy status of the property (whether it is lived in by people).
What does the term REO stand for in real estate?	Real Estate Owned, referring to properties where the lender has taken title after foreclosure.
What does FTV stand for in a property condition report?	First-Time Vacancy, the initial report confirming a property is empty.
What is a primary responsibility of a mortgage field inspector regarding a property's address?	To verify the address by photographing the house number and nearest street sign.
A field inspector must never discuss a borrower's loan status due to potential violations of which federal act?	The Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA).
Instead of stating a roof 'needs to be replaced' (a diagnosis), what should an objective report state?	An objective report should describe the observation, such as 'Shingles are missing from the south-facing slope'.
What is the NAMFS standard photo format for field inspections?	JPG / JPEG.
What is the recommended minimum resolution for photos according to the NAMFS Industry Photo Standard?	640 x 480 pixels.
What is the maximum file size for a photo under the NAMFS standard?	300 KB.
According to NAMFS standards, what color and font should the date/timestamp watermark be on a photo?	Red font, using Helvetica or an equivalent.
What critical metadata is automatically embedded in photos taken with apps like InspectorADE or Focus?	A date/time stamp, GPS coordinates, and the inspector's unique ID.
What is the fraudulent practice of completing a report without visiting the property called?	Desk-flipping.
What is the required orientation for all photos taken during a mortgage field inspection?	Landscape mode (horizontal).
What is the first photo required by the '6-Angle Rule' for exterior inspections?	The nearest street sign.
What is the second photo required by the '6-Angle Rule' for exterior inspections?	A clear, close-up shot of the house number.
The front elevation photo of a property should cover the entire roofline with approximately how much open space on all sides?	Approximately 5% open space.
What must inspectors avoid having in their photos to prevent the appearance of a 'drive-by' inspection?	Car parts, such as dashboards, mirrors, or window frames.
In occupancy determination, what is the key principle regarding furniture and people?	Furniture does not occupy property; people occupy property.
What is an example of a primary indicator that a property is occupied?	The homeowner answers the door, cars are in the driveway, or a neighbor confirms residency.
What is a primary indicator that a property is vacant?	Tall grass and weeds, 'Off' tags on utility meters, or piled-up mail.
What is a secondary indicator that a property might be occupied?	Freshly cut lawns, trash cans at the curb, or holiday decorations.
What is a non-invasive tool inspectors can use on an exterior outlet to check for active power at a property?	A non-contact volt stick.
What is the recommended phrasing when asking a neighbor about a property's occupancy status?	"When did the people next door move out?"
What restriction applies to inspections of properties that are 'No-Contact' or in bankruptcy?	The inspector is strictly forbidden from knocking on the door or speaking to neighbors.
What is a 'stay violation' in the context of a bankruptcy inspection?	It occurs when an inspector violates a 'no-contact' order, which can lead to legal action for harassing a debtor.
When leaving a message for an occupant, the sealed envelope should be marked with what phrase?	"Personal and Confidential".
What is a compliance-safe phrase to state your purpose when an occupant answers the door?	"I am conducting a property condition verification for your mortgage company."
What are some 'trigger words' an inspector must never use when speaking with an occupant?	Delinquency, default, arrears, past due, or foreclosure.
If an occupant becomes belligerent, what is the correct protocol for the inspector?	De-escalate the situation and leave the property immediately.
In a canine encounter, why is running from an approaching dog prohibited?	Running may trigger the dog's prey instinct, making it more likely to chase and bite.
If a dog attack seems unavoidable, what should a field worker use as a barrier?	A bag, clipboard, or jacket to shield vital areas like the face, neck, and hands.
Before approaching a yard, what are some signs that a dog may be present?	'Beware of Dog' signs, dog toys, water bowls, or fencing.
Characterizing a person's behavior as 'rude and belligerent' is an example of ____ documentation.	subjective
Describing an action, such as 'Subject suddenly banged their fist on the table,' is an example of ____ documentation.	objective
Why should inspectors avoid adjectives like 'overwhelmingly' in their reports?	Such words are subjective emphasis that can open the report up to criticism of bias.
During an interior inspection of a vacant property, what is the minimum number of photos required?	26 minimum photos.
During an interior inspection, how should a toilet be photographed?	Standing over the toilet looking straight down to capture the tank bottom and the bowl in one shot.
What is the purpose of photographing the toilet bowl and tank during an interior inspection?	To show how much, if any, anti-freeze is present in the tank and bowl for winterization verification.
If an inspector arrives at a property and the provided lockbox combination does not work, what must they photograph?	A clear photo of the lockbox tumblers in the position of the combination that was provided.
If a key from a lockbox is missing, what should an inspector photograph as proof?	A photo of the empty lockbox key storage chamber.
What is the industry-standard key set used to enter vacant properties that have been secured?	A HUD key set.
What is the NAMFS recommended format for video documentation?	MP4 is preferred, with AVI as an alternative.
To balance evidence capture with review burden, what is the NAMFS recommended maximum recording length for videos?	Approximately 30 seconds.
What information should be included in the metadata for video files according to NAMFS standards?	Timestamp, GPS, and an order reference embedded or associated with the file.
What is a 'curbside' or 'drive-by' inspection?	An exterior inspection conducted from a vehicle, only authorized under specific circumstances like legal constraints or danger to the inspector.
Under Fannie Mae guidelines, when is an interior inspection required for a vacant or abandoned property?	An interior inspection must be completed every calendar month until the foreclosure sale date.
The federal agency that sets specific preservation and inspection standards for certain government-backed loans is the ____.	Federal Housing Administration (FHA)
When is an inspector permitted to conduct an interior inspection on an occupied property?	Never; inspectors must not attempt to conduct an interior inspection on an occupied property.
According to the National Risk Services orientation, what is the turnaround time for a standard inspection?	20 days from the date of assignment.
What is the required turnaround time for a 'RUSH' inspection according to the National Risk Services guide?	As soon as possible, but no later than 10 days from the date of assignment.
What type of personal protective equipment (PPE) is recommended when inspecting a shipment of live birds to protect against psittacosis or histoplasmosis?	A disposable N or P-100 filter respirator, a Tyvek® suit, a face shield, and gloves.
What does EXIF data in a digital photograph typically log?	It logs camera settings, lens info, ISO, and timestamps.
Why is it risky to leave GPS coordinates enabled when photographing high-value items at home for insurance?	The photo's metadata could embed your home address directly into the file, creating a privacy and security risk.
To avoid having a photo rejected, what common compositional error related to the subject property must be avoided?	Missing part of the rooftop in the front elevation shot.
If a field inspector encounters a gas or water leak at a property, what is the immediate protocol?	Contact the local utility company to have the service repaired or turned off, then report the condition to their account manager.
When inspecting properties with mold, a health hazard should be reported if the mold covers an area larger than ____.	2 square feet

How should an inspector sign their name on a property's sign-in sheet?	They should enter the company name followed by their initials (e.g., NMFS / JI).
According to the U.S. Postal Service, how many postal employees were attacked by dogs in 2022?	Over 5,300.
If a dog is showing signs of fear or anxiety (tucked tail, pinned ears), why might it still be dangerous?	It may lash out if it feels cornered.
What is the purpose of a monopod for a field inspector, according to the National Risk Services guide?	It is a requirement for taking roof photos.
What type of computer operating system is required to run the proprietary 'Focus' software from National Risk Services?	A computer running Windows 8 or 10.
What does 'TPO' stand for in the context of mortgage quality control?	Third-Party Originations.
According to the 2025 Fannie Mae updates, lenders must self-report loans with identified defects within how many days of the QC report's publication?	Within 30 days.
What is the 3-2-1 rule for backing up digital evidence like insurance photos?	Keep three copies of the data, on two different types of media, with one copy stored offsite.
For archiving purposes, what is a superior file format to JPEG that captures all details and metadata without lossy compression?	RAW or TIFF files.
Why must an inspector photograph ALL doors at a property if a lockbox appears to be missing?	To verify that the lockbox is not present on a rear or side door, as it may have been moved.
What is the primary duty of a field inspector?	To meticulously assess conditions and create comprehensive reports based on predefined criteria for relevant stakeholders.
An inspector who determines the condition of a structure is a home inspector, whereas an inspector who determines the value of a property is a(n) _____.	appraiser